MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 3/20/2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

Unapproved minutes
February 21, 2024

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 2 Dale Majewski, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 3 Samantha Pitchford and District 6 Jack Kleinhardt

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the agenda, **motion carried.**

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of January 17, 2024, **motion carried.**

It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the Committee of the Whole Minutes of February 7, 2024, **motion carried.**

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

None

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps provided the Board of Commissioners with updates from the Governor's office suggesting 5% increase for revenue sharing, which would total $80,000.00. There is a state Medicaid program being introduced which would pay for medical expenses for inmates. In addition House Bill 1115 is being introduced, which would allow federal Medicaid to cover expenses of inmates while in jail. Middle Michigan Development has a new representative, Allison Heinrick and Administrator Phelps has been named Vice-Chair of the East Michigan Council of Governments.

Administrator Phelps informed the Board of Commissioners that the State of Michigan EGLE is now requiring counties to put a composting plan together. Administrator Phelps and Commissioner Fancon are working together on that plan.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Eric Karboski, District Director of MSU Extension
   Michelle Neff Supervisor for District 6 filled in for Director Karboski. Supervisor Neff thanked the County Commissioner Board for all of their support over the years, gave a housing counselor update, which included the closing of the program that helped people from losing their property to back taxes. Miranda Warmuskerken, the 4-H Coordinator, discussed many events they have hosted for community involvement and talked about the Mock Interview Day for high school students they are currently working on.

2. Doug Lewis, Director of New Dawn Shelter
   Mr. Lewis was not present.

3. Ed Hubel, Clare County Community Foundation
   Mr. Ed Hubel spoke on behalf of the Clare County Community Foundation Sharon Mortensen gave a presentation on the Talent Attraction Program and the Annual Report. Ms. Mortensen asked the Board of Commissioners to pass a resolution and sign a fund agreement.

JUSTICE

None

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Clare County Community Foundation
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to adopt Resolution #24-07 entering into a joint effort with the Midland Area Community Foundation to implement the Talent Attraction Program for Clare County, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (6) being Commissioners Hoefling, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Fancon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (3) being Commissioners Housler, Pitchford and Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of January 22, 2024 in the amount of $87,329.20 and minutes of February 5, 2024 in the amount of $153,439.38, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (6) being Commissioners Majewski, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Fancon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (3) being Commissioners Housler, Pitchford and Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the expenditures for the month of January, 2024 in the amount of $2,655,373.00 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,033,003.93, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (6) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Majewski, Gilmore, Fancon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (3) being Commissioners Housler, Pitchford and Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Gilmore, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Budget Adjustments 24-52, in the amount of $75,732.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (6) being Commissioners Gilmore, Majewski, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Fancon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (3) being Commissioners Housler, Pitchford and Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott gave an update regarding Clare County's first ever early voting with 58 voters utilizing the service as of Tuesday evening. With the help of members of her team/staff (Stacy, Christina, Pam and Brittany), six Local Clerks (Hatton, Frost, Hayes, Harrison, Clare and Hamilton), four Deputy Clerks (Frost, Garfield, Sheridan and Clare) and four security guards (Brent, Jamie, Paul and Brian) early voting has been successful.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. Her office is in the middle of tax season and reminded the public that the deadline on a judicial foreclosure, to ask for extension from judge, is February 22, 2022 and urged anyone in danger of losing their property to contact her office because she can still work with them until the March 31, 2024 deadline.

Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger also reminded everyone that the deadline to purchase a dog license without a late fee is February 29, 2024.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman Jeff Haskell asked Administrator Phelps for an update on meeting date for ambulance service – there is no date yet.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Dale Majewski has been attending his meetings and also had feedback on ambulance service.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and each township had mini public hearings where residents could express their concerns regarding the ambulance service because everyone was not able to attend the meeting at the County.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT – continued

Commissioner Ambrozaitis also has had a lot of feedback on the ambulance service issue, confirmed the next meeting date for the airport committee and reported on the expansion of the road commission.

Commissioner Gilmore also questioned when the next meeting on the ambulance service will be held.

Commissioner Fancon met with Isabella County to work together on Part 115, which is the path to zero landfills. He reported that as part of that bill there will be hidden taxes and fees that will be passed onto consumer. The State of Michigan has lowest cost for out of state landfills to dump in Michigan, which leads many other states and Canada to bring their garbage to Michigan.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps reported that as of the end of February the budget would normally be expected to be 42% expended and it is currently at 37.19% expended. She will continue to monitor the budget and report any progress or issues.

Administrator Phelps is working on the 2025 Budget and will be bringing PA 152 costs and eight union negotiations to the Board of Commissioners.

PUBLIC COMMENT

One member of the public asked if the 2% of revenue sharing that must be used on public safety could be used for increased ambulance services. Administrator Phelps confirmed that could happen, but that would only be $1,580.00.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

Meeting Adjourned at 9:49 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

Jeff Haskell, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners